CSCI 435/535 - Software Engineering

ponytail

The lazy senior dev for your AI agent



The Problem

AI coding agents over-engineer.

Ponytail makes it write the least code that works.

(Like a senior dev who's been paged at 3am one too many times.)

54% less code	27% faster	20% lower API cost

Why this tool?

Why not just ask Claude to "keep it simple?"

A one-off prompt only works once.

Ponytail injects the same ruleset automatically on every turn & every session.

So there is no need to remember to ask.

Setup

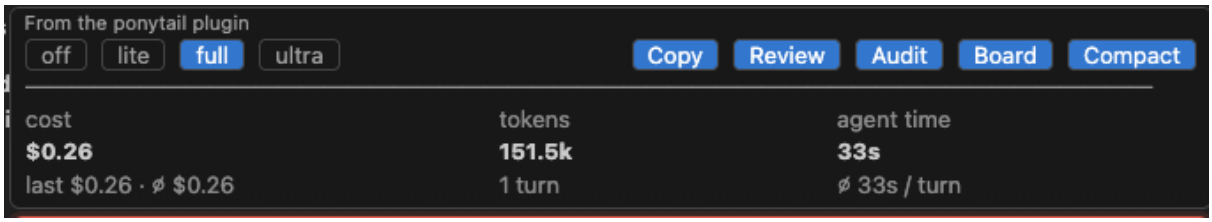
1	/plugin marketplace add DietrichGebert/ponytail
2	/plugin install ponytail@ponytail

When to use it

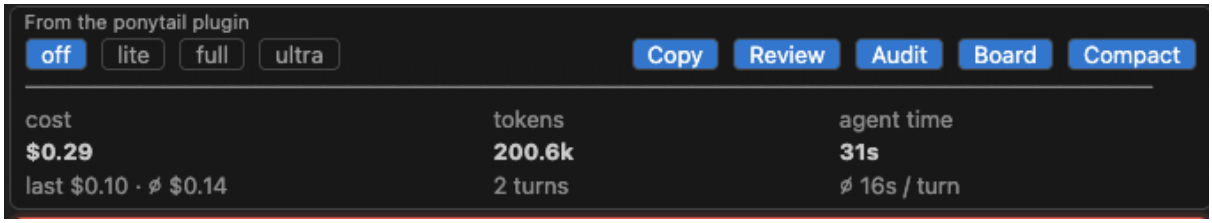
- You use Claude Code and delete half of what it generates
- You want lower API costs without changing your workflow
- No benefit without an AI coding agent
- Requires Node.js on PATH for always-on activation

Screenshots of Results

With ponytail:



Without ponytail:



Cost: Free, open source (MIT).

Video Link: https://youtu.be/-MtujRsHjWQ